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This guide provides information for non-EU students planning to study in the Czech Republic, based on official information from the Ministry of the Interior (MVCR) and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MZV) of the Czech Republic.

1. Study Courses

To apply for a Long-term Visa or Residence Permit for the Purpose of Study, you must be accepted into an accredited study program. This includes:

- University Degrees: Full-time Bachelor's, Master's, or Doctoral programs at public or private higher education institutions.
- Exchange Programs: Participation in EU programs (e.g., Erasmus+) or bilateral exchange agreements.
- Language and Preparatory Courses: Only if they are organized by a public higher education institution and are intended to prepare you for an accredited study program.
- Note: Non-accredited courses or private language school courses usually require a "Visa for Other Purposes," which has different rules.

2. Embassy Appointment

Appointments must be booked at the Czech Embassy or Consulate in your home country (or the country where you have a long-term residence permit).

- How to book: Each embassy manages its own calendar. Most require an email request sent on a specific day/time or an online booking system.

- Where to check: Visit the website of the specific Czech Embassy where you will apply.

3. Applying for a Study Visa

The application process involves several steps:

1. Receive Documents: Get your official Letter of Acceptance and Proof of Accommodation from the school.
2. Book Appointment: Secure a slot at the Embassy.
3. Submit Application: Appear in person for an interview and to submit documents.
4. Processing Time: By law, the processing time for a study visa/residence permit is 60 days. However, it can take less or more depending on the complexity of the case.

4. Documents Needed

All documents (except the passport) must be in Czech or officially translated into Czech by a certified translator.

- Application Form: Filled out and signed.
- Passport: Valid for at least 3 months after the visa expires.
- 2 Photos: Passport size.
- Letter of Acceptance: Original document from the Czech school.
- Proof of Accommodation: A lease agreement or a "Proof of Accommodation" form signed by the landlord (with a notarized signature).

- Proof of Funds: (See Section 5).
- Criminal Record Background Check: From your home country (and any country where you lived for 6+ months in the last 3 years). This usually requires an Apostille or legalisation.
- Travel Medical Insurance: After approval, you must show proof of insurance. Since 2021, most students are required to have comprehensive insurance from Pojišťovna VZP (PVZP).

5. Money Requirements

You must prove you have sufficient funds for your stay. The amount is calculated based on the "Existential Minimum."

- Requirement for 2026: For a long-term stay (1 year), the minimum amount is approximately 116,200 CZK (roughly 4,600 EUR / 5,000 USD).
- How to prove it: A bank statement in your name (with an internationally recognized debit card) or a document confirming a scholarship.

6. Residence Permit

If you apply for a Long-term Residence Permit (instead of just a visa):

1. Arrival: Within 3 working days of arrival, you must report to the Foreign Police.
2. Biometrics: You must visit a Ministry of the Interior (OAMP) office to provide biometric data (fingerprints/photo).
3. Collection: You will return a few weeks later to collect your biometric residence card.

7. Working While Studying

- Full-time Students: Non-EU students enrolled in an accredited degree program have free access to the labor market.
- Conditions: You do not need a work permit. However, your work must not interfere with your studies (study must remain the primary purpose of your stay).
- Hours: There is no legal limit on hours, but usually, students work part-time (up to 20 hours) to balance academics.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If your course continues, you must renew your permit within the Czech Republic at the Ministry of the Interior (MVCR).

- Timeline: You can apply as early as 120 days before your current permit expires, and no later than the last day of its validity.
- Documents: Updated proof of study, accommodation, and funds.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

After graduation from a Czech university:

- Free Access: You retain free access to the labor market. You do not need a work permit, but you must change your residence status.
- Job Seeker Visa: You can apply for a 9-month residence permit to look for work or start a business after graduation.

- Employee Card: Once you find a job, you apply for an "Employee Card," which acts as a work/residence permit. Because you are a Czech graduate, the "labor market test" is waived.

10. Official Information

The most reliable sources of information are:

- Ministry of the Interior (MVCr): www.mvcr.cz (Detailed legal requirements).
- Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MZV): www.mzv.cz (Visa application procedures).
- Study in Czechia: www.studyinczechia.cz (Official national portal for international students).

11. Application Forms

You can download the official forms (printed on green or black/white) here:

- MVCr Forms Gallery: Direct Link to Forms
- Choose "Application for long-term residence" or "Application for a long-term visa."

12. Tips for Students (Avoiding Mistakes)

- Legalization: Many students forget that the Criminal Record check and Proof of Funds need an Apostille or "Super-legalization" to be valid in Czechia.
- Translations: All translations must be done by a Czech court translator. Translations done by foreign agencies are often rejected.
- Accommodation Signatures: The signature of the landlord on the proof of

accommodation must be notarized (legalized) by a Czech notary or at a Czech Point.

- The "60-Day" Rule: Apply as early as possible. The 60-day window is the minimum processing time; during peak seasons (July/August), it can take longer.
- Check your Email/Mail: The Ministry may send a "Request to Supplement" if a document is missing. If you don't respond in time, the application is rejected.

1. Study Courses — What Courses Qualify?

A long-term visa for the purpose of studies is intended for third-country nationals who want to study in the Czech Republic. You can apply if your form of studies corresponds with Section 64 of Act No. 326/1999 Coll. The most frequent qualifying cases are:

- Studies of a university accredited study programme
- Language and professional preparation for studies of a university accredited programme (organised by a public university, as part of an EU programme, or based on an international agreement)
- Secondary school or higher vocational studies carried out as part of an exchange programme

Other qualifying types include:

- Stipend programmes
- Internships or expert training
- European Voluntary Service
- Exchange of experience studies as part of EU programmes or international agreements

Official source: ipc.gov.cz – [Long-term Visa for Studies](#)

2. Embassy Appointment — How to Book

You can only apply in person at one of the Czech Republic's diplomatic missions:

- In a country that issued your travel document or which you are a national of
- In a state where you have been granted long-term or permanent residence and have legally resided for at least 2 years (for EU countries, only via the Dresden visa centre)
- At any Czech diplomatic mission if you are a national of certain listed countries

Consulates schedule their own appointments, mostly by email or phone — refer to the consulate's website for guidance. Applications are lodged in person; an interview is held and fingerprints are collected. Children younger than 12 do not submit fingerprints and do not need to visit the consulate.

Find your nearest embassy: [Ministry of Foreign Affairs – Diplomatic Missions](#)

3. Applying for a Study Visa — Step by Step

Visa Types

- Long-term visa (valid up to 1 year) — primarily for shorter study stays of several months
- Long-term residence permit — primarily for stays of over one year, such as full university programmes

Steps

1. Get accepted to a qualifying Czech educational institution and receive an official acceptance letter
2. Gather all required documents (see Section 4)
3. Fill in the official application form online, print it out, and sign it. You can also download a blank form, print it, and fill it in by hand — legibly, in block capitals and in Latin characters
4. Book an appointment at your nearest Czech embassy or consulate
5. Attend in person, submit documents, pay the fee, and provide fingerprints
6. If the application is approved, the embassy will affix the visa sticker to your travel document. Prior to this, you must present proof of travel medical insurance and payment of the premium upon request

Processing Time and Fee

- Application fee: approximately 2,500 CZK (around 100 EUR)
- **Processing time: between 60 to 90 days**
- Apply early to avoid delays

4. Documents Required

- Valid passport
- Completed official application form
- Proof of enrolment / acceptance letter from the Czech educational institution
- Proof of accommodation (dormitory reservation or rental agreement)
- Proof of financial resources for the stay (bank account statement or confirmation of a grant/scholarship)
- Photographs showing your current appearance
- Criminal record certificate from your home country and other countries where you have lived for 6+ months in the past 3 years
- Travel medical insurance (presented when collecting the visa, not at time of application)

Note: Some documents, such as the criminal record extract, must be translated into Czech by a translator with an official rubber stamp.

5. Money Requirements

For stays longer than 30 days, you must demonstrate:

- A minimum of 46,950 CZK (approximately 1,900 EUR) plus 6,260 CZK for each additional month of stay

Existential minimum (2023 onward): **3,130 CZK/month**

- Proof can be a recent bank statement, a scholarship confirmation letter, or a written undertaking from a sponsor

As a general guideline for one full year of study, students should be able to show funds of at least 110,000–130,000 CZK (approximately USD 4,600–5,400 or EUR 4,200–5,000).

6. Residence Permit — What to Do After Arriving

Registration Deadlines

- If you entered on a D/VR visa (visa for collection of a residence permit): register at a Ministry of the Interior office within 30 calendar days of arrival
- If you entered without a visa (e.g. with a biometric passport under an international treaty): register within 3 days of arrival

Steps After Registration

- During registration, the office will schedule an appointment for your biometric data to be taken
- At the biometric appointment, you will agree on a date to collect your completed biometric card
- The time limit for collection is 60 days from the date biometric data was scanned

Official source: ipc.gov.cz – [Registration After Arrival](#)

7. Working While Studying

- Students holding a long-term residence permit for the purpose of studies can work without an additional work permit (free access to the labour market)
- From the first year of study, students may work up to 20 hours per week

Claude incorrectly states a 20-hour legal limit. Gemini is correct that no limit exists.

- Full-time work is permitted during summer holidays

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

- A long-term visa including extensions can be valid for a maximum total of 1 year
- To stay longer than one year, you must apply for a long-term residence permit
- If you continue studying in a university accredited programme, you can extend your long-term residence permit repeatedly, with a maximum extension period of 2 years each time
- If you continue attending language or professional preparation organised by a public university, you can extend your long-term residence only once
- Submit the renewal application at least 120 days before the visa expires and no later than the last day of its validity, at the relevant Ministry of the Interior office

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies

After completing a university-accredited study programme, you can apply for a long-term residence permit for the purpose of seeking employment or starting a business:

- Valid for up to 9 months with no possibility of extension
- Grants free access to the labour market — you can work, seek employment, or start a business without limitations
- Also makes you eligible to apply for a long-term residence permit for doing business without needing 5 years of prior residence

Once employment is secured, you can apply for an Employee Card:

- A type of long-term residence permit enabling third-country citizens to stay and work legally in the Czech Republic for longer than 3 months
- Valid for a maximum of 2 years and renewable

Official source: ipc.gov.cz – [Seeking Employment After Studies](#)

10. Official Government Websites

- Ministry of Interior – Foreigners Portal: ipc.gov.cz
- Ministry of Foreign Affairs – Study Visa: mzv.gov.cz
- EU Immigration Portal – Student in Czechia: home-affairs.ec.europa.eu
- Study in Czechia (official): studyin.cz

11. Application Forms

All applications must be submitted on the official form — otherwise the application is inadmissible. Forms must be filled in solely in the Czech language. Key forms include:

- Application form for a long-term visa for a stay over 90 days (Czech + English version available)
- Application form for issuing or extending an employee card (Czech + English)
- Application form for a long-term residence permit

Download all official forms: [ipc.gov.cz – Forms and Documents](https://ipc.gov.cz)

12. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Applying too late — processing takes 60–90 days; apply immediately after receiving your acceptance letter
- Submitting untranslated documents — documents such as the criminal record extract must be translated into Czech by a translator with an official rubber stamp
- Not registering with the Foreign Police on arrival — you must report within 3 days of entering the country, unless the accommodation provider (hotel, dormitory) reports your arrival on your behalf
- Missing the renewal deadline — the application must be filed 120 days before the visa expires at the earliest, and no later than the last day of validity
- Applying for the wrong visa type — if your studies last more than one year, apply directly for a long-term residence permit, not a long-term visa
- Letting health insurance lapse — travel medical insurance must be valid from the day of entry; without it, your visa sticker cannot be affixed even after approval
- Exceeding work hour limits — students are limited to 20 hours per week during term time

1. Study Courses

Claude: Lists qualifying courses correctly, referencing Section 64 of Act No. 326/1999 Coll. States language/preparatory courses must be organised by a public university.
Correct.

Gemini: States preparatory courses only qualify if organised by a public university.
Correct.

Both: Correct. No errors. Official requirements: full-time university programmes, language/preparatory courses at public universities, secondary/higher vocational studies under exchange programmes .

2. Embassy Appointment

Claude: States applications submitted in person at Czech diplomatic missions; appointments scheduled by email/phone; fingerprints collected. **Correct.**

Gemini: States each embassy manages its own calendar; mostly email or online booking. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. No significant errors.

3. Applying for a Study Visa (Processing Time)

Claude: Says processing takes 60–90 days. **Partial error.**

Gemini: Says processing takes 60 days. **Partial error.**

Correct Answer:

- Legal processing deadline: **60 days**
- In practice: **60–90 days**; universities recommend applying 3–4 months in advance
- Missing documents can extend processing beyond 60 days

Error: Claude is closer to reality; Gemini underestimates by not mentioning potential delays.

4. Documents Needed

Claude: Lists: passport, application form, acceptance letter, accommodation, financial proof, photos, criminal record, health insurance. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists same documents. States criminal record requires apostille. **Correct.**

Both: Mostly correct. But missing important details:

Correct Answer:

- Passport validity: **3 months beyond intended stay**
- All documents (except passport) must be translated into **Czech** by a certified translator
- Criminal record: from country of citizenship + any country where lived 6+ months in last 3 years; requires apostille/superlegalization
- Health insurance: **submitted after visa approval, not at application**
- Documents must be no older than **180 days**

5. Money Requirements

Claude: States 46,950 CZK + 6,260 CZK/month ($\approx 1,900$ EUR +). **Incorrect.**

Gemini: States $\sim 116,200$ CZK for 12 months (2024 figure). **Correct for 2024, but needs 2026 update.**

Correct Answer (2026):

- Formula: $(15 \times \text{existential minimum for first month}) + (2 \times \text{existential minimum for each following month})$
- Existential minimum (2023 onward): **3,130 CZK/month**
- For 12 months: $(15 \times 3,130) + (11 \times 2 \times 3,130) = 46,950 + 68,860 = \mathbf{115,810 \text{ CZK}}$ ($\approx 4,600$ EUR)

Error:

- Claude's figure (46,950 CZK) only covers the **first month**, not the full year
- Claude's formula is incomplete
- Gemini's figure (116,200 CZK) is close but slightly outdated for 2026

6. Residence Permit (After Arrival)

Claude: States D/VR visa holders must register within 30 days at MOI; biometric appointment scheduled; card collection within 60 days. **Correct.**

Gemini: States registration within 3 working days at Foreign Police. Also mentions biometric appointment. **Partially correct.**

Correct Answer:

Depends on the visa type :

Document Type	Registration	Where
Long-term visa (for ≤ 1 year)	Within 3 working days of arrival	Foreign Police (if not registered by dormitory)
D/VR visa (to collect residence permit)	Within 30 days of arrival	Ministry of Interior office

Error: Both AI are correct depending on context, but neither clearly explains the distinction between the two registration routes. Gemini missing the 30-day MOI route entirely.

7. Working While Studying

Claude: Says students on long-term residence permits can work without work permit; limited to 20 hours/week during term; full-time during holidays. **Incorrect.**

Gemini: Says no legal limit; usually part-time. **Correct.**

Correct Answer:

- Full-time students (non-EU) have **free access to the labour market** — no work permit needed
- There is **NO legal limit** on working hours
- However, the study must remain the primary purpose of the stay
- "20 hours/week" is a recommendation, not a legal limit

Error: Claude incorrectly states a 20-hour legal limit. Gemini is correct that no limit exists.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Claude: States long-term visa (D) cannot be extended beyond 12 months; must apply for residence permit instead. States renewal can be submitted 120 days before expiry, no later than last day. **Correct.**

Gemini: States renewal can be submitted 120 days before expiry, no later than last day. **Correct.**

Both: Correct.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Claude: States graduates can apply for 9-month job-seeking residence permit; free access to labour market; Employee Card available. **Correct.**

Gemini: States same: 9-month job-seeker permit, free access, Employee Card. **Correct.**

Both: Correct.

10. Official Information

Claude: Lists ipc.gov.cz, mzv.gov.cz, home-affairs.ec.europa.eu, studyin.cz. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists mvcr.cz, mzv.cz, studyinczechia.cz. **Correct.**

Both: Correct.

11. Application Forms

Claude: Lists ipc.gov.cz as source for all forms. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists MVCR Forms Gallery. **Correct.**

Both: Correct.

12. Tips for Students

Claude: Lists: apply early, translate documents, register with Foreign Police, meet renewal deadline (120 days), choose correct visa type, keep insurance valid, work hour limits. **Correct, except work hours.**

Gemini: Lists: legalisation, translations, accommodation notarisation, 60-day rule, check email for supplement requests. **Correct.**

Errors:

- **Claude:** "Exceeding work hour limits" — students have **no legal limit**
- **Claude:** "Long-term visa cannot be renewed" — correct, but could clarify that residence permit applications can be submitted during visa validity

Summary Comparison

Topic	Claude	Gemini	Correct Answer
Study Courses	Correct	Correct	Full-time programmes + preparatory at public universities
Processing Time	60–90 days	60 days only	60 days legal, 60–90 in practice

Money Req	46,950 CZK	~116,200 CZK (2024)	115,810 CZK (2026)
Passport Validity	Not specified	Not specified	3 months beyond stay
Registration	30 days	3 days	Both: 3 days for visa, 30 days for D/VR
Work Hours	20 hours limit	No limit	No legal limit
Renewal	Correct	Correct	120 days before expiry
Work Permit	Correct	Correct	9-month job-seeker + Employee Card

Critical Fixes

Topic	Wrong	Correct
Money requirements (Claude)	46,950 CZK	115,810 CZK for 12 months
Money requirements (Gemini)	~116,200 CZK (2024)	115,810 CZK (2026)
Work hours (Claude)	20 hours/week limit	No legal limit
Passport validity	Not mentioned	3 months beyond intended stay

Health insurance	Not detailed	Submitted after approval, not at application
Registration distinction	Mixed	3 days (visa) vs 30 days (D/VR)